DevOps Infrastructure – Unit 2 Notes (Part 7)

Authentication and Access Tokens

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1. Authentication in Docker

Definition

Authentication ensures that only authorized users can:

- Push images
- Pull private images

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2. Docker Login

Command

docker login

What Happens

- User enters username and password
- Credentials are stored locally
- Access is granted to registry

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3. Access Tokens

Definition

Access tokens are secure alternatives to passwords used for authentication.

Why Tokens are Used

- More secure than passwords
- Can be limited in scope

- Can be revoked easily

Example Use

- CI/CD pipelines
- Automated deployments

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4. Token-Based Authentication Flow

1. Generate token from registry
2. Use token instead of password
3. Authenticate using docker login

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5. Best Practices

- Never hardcode credentials
- Use environment variables
- Use short-lived tokens
- Rotate tokens regularly

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6. Summary

- Authentication secures access to registries
- docker login is used for authentication
- Access tokens provide secure, flexible access
- Essential for CI/CD and automation